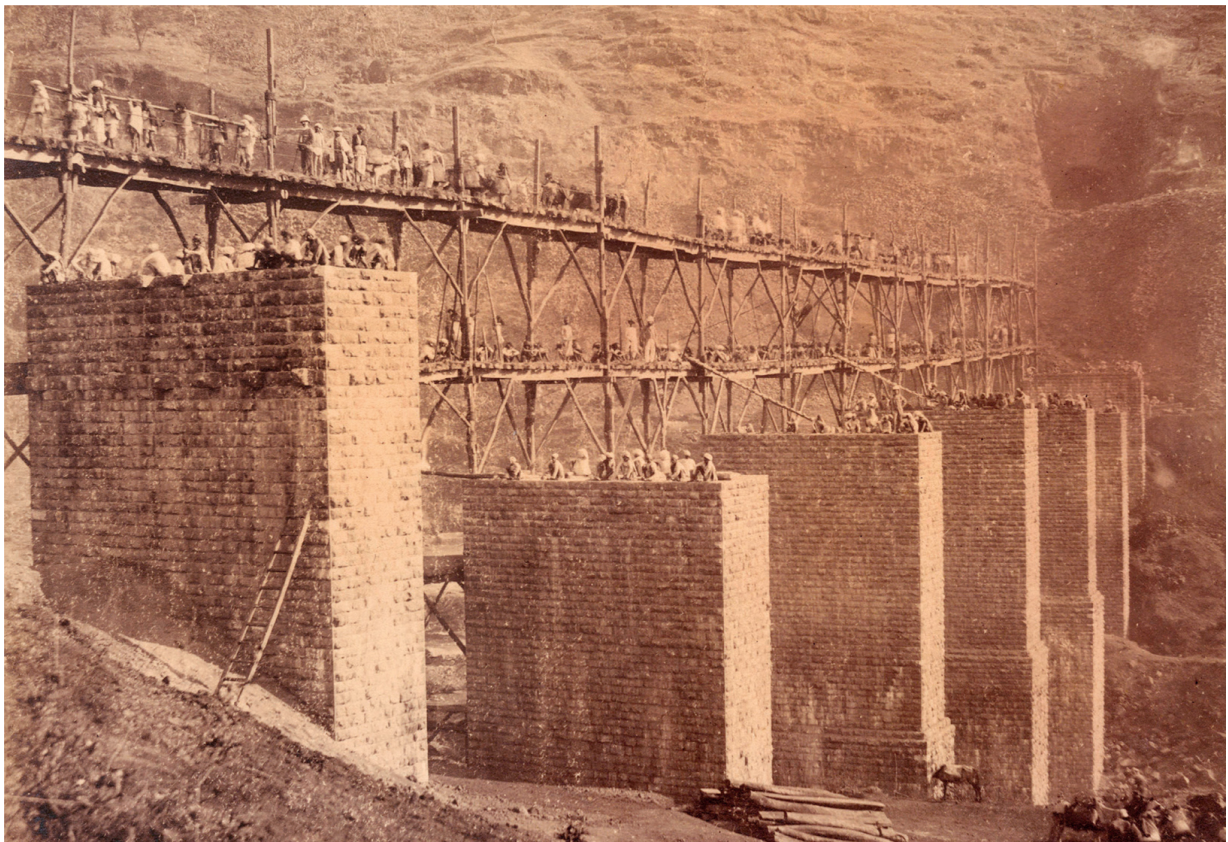


By 1856, GIPR's line had extended from Bombay to Khopoli, beyond which extended the hills of Bhore Ghat. Two years later in 1858, another line had connected Poona to the hill town of Khandala from the other side. What remained now was a link between Khopoli and Khandala with the mighty Ghats in between.

Challenges and innovations

Constructing a direct line seemed impossible even with such a short route because of the steep incline – the railway line would have to ascend up to 600 m in 24 km. Then Berkley hit upon an innovative solution. Instead of a continuous track that would plod uphill, Berkley proposed a reversing station at the top of the hill.

The track would be laid in a Z-shaped formation. The train would go upwards in reverse on to tracks laid out on an elevation and then move forward to climb further up. This would keep the gradient within the hauling power of the locomotives that would be pulling the trains.



▲ **Native labourers** were at constant risk due to unsafe work conditions. They often worked on temporary wooden structures with basic tools and no protective gear.